Thanks again for writing. Below is a response from Anthony to your inquiry. We hope it proves helpful.

We are glad to provide some clarification for you and members of your region, and I have copied your Regional Delegate on this response. To begin, a great resource for staying current with NAWS activities is *NAWS News*, available via e-subscription (www.na.org/subscribe) or our NA Meetings app. As part of our regular Conference participant web meetings, we continue to update Conference participants on every lawsuit, as we can share information considering that some are ongoing.

The Philippines and Russia suits are not resolved yet, and therefore we have not reported all the details of either thus far. The Russian suit was a claim that NA literature is anti-Russian and anti-church. Not only did we have to go to court, but we also had to have our literature reviewed and certified in Russia. The suit in the Philippines is an effort by an individual to own the NA name in that country. Regarding the suit brought by those individuals calling themselves the Autonomous Region, we were able to report that the cost of the initial phase of that suit was over $200,000 once that initial suit was adjudicated and the claims made were not upheld. Check the December 2020 *NAWS News* for more on that suit. Unfortunately, the individuals who brought the initial suit have filed an appeal, so additional costs to NAWS are unavoidable.

We agree that we would much rather spend time and funds on other efforts, but the fact is, the US and Russia suits were not filed by NAWS, but rather by individuals. We have no choice but to defend against the suits, and of course, that requires funds. Additionally, NAWS has been assigned the responsibility of protecting NA's trademarks and copyrighted literature. We make every effort to resolve those issues without taking legal action, but when there is no other option, that is the path we must take to fulfill our assigned responsibility. That responsibility is assigned by the WSC and so it is primarily to Conference participants that we provide ongoing information as we are able. We wish that NA members would recognize and honor the fellowship's wishes and decisions regarding the use and ownership of NA's intellectual property so that we might redirect the money and energy used in these legal actions.

Regarding literature support to communities in need, we continue to provide free and subsidized literature to any community that asks. The fellowship has determined the guidelines for reproducing NA literature, and we do our best to inform and support those places that can't afford to purchase literature. As an example, we provided $579,157 in free and subsidized literature to NA communities worldwide in the fiscal year ending 30 June 2020. In the prior fiscal year, it was even higher. The NAWS Annual report is a great resource for this and other financial information. Here is that link: https://www.na.org/?ID=ar-2019 And by the way, we recently completed a video that discusses the FIPT and related topics. Here is that link: https://youtu.be/CYaMptZUde0

Regarding the $500,000, I believe that what you are referencing is the cost of the World Service Conference, not a convention. It is a fact that the WSC costs NAWS around $500,000, and considering the current financial situation, the WB chair stated on a CP webinar that we had spent about half of the cost of a WSC already on the current legal petition. Our financial statements for the fiscal year ending 30 June 2020 show legal expenses of $442,880 compared to the budgeted amount of $40,912. In the next fiscal year through December 2020, legal expenses were $182,204 compared to a budgeted amount of $19,000. Conference participants have received all of that information and the reasons for it and have been provided the opportunity to ask questions. We have done a rather amazing job at reducing expenses in almost all other areas within our control.

We do not publish detailed information about those who provide services to NAWS beyond those assigned with an oversight responsibility, the World Board. Unfortunately, when we did that in the past, some of our members targeted those providers. We

continue to provide as much information as we can to WSC participants, as we are directly accountable to that service body. We understand that some members may want more information more quickly. We are doing our best.

In pursuit of our Vision

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